RAFAEL LEITÃO

Product Engineer transitioning into Product Management

Munich, Germany | +49 177 705 1788 | carlosrafael093@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/carlos-rafael-leitao

Product Engineer moving into Product Management by doing the job before having the title: recently led the team's product process as interim PM/PO, currently working closely with our UX designer and UX researcher on UX/UI topics, and using behavioural data and AI-assisted analysis to find the problems worth solving. My engineering background helps me weigh user needs against technical feasibility and work closely with engineers. Outside work, I spotted an overlooked niche in how footballers are represented online and shipped live websites for real athletes.

EXPERIENCE

Product Engineer — AroundHome GmbH — Remote *Sep 2023 – Present*

Aug 2026 - Oct 2026: covered core Product Owner/PM responsibilities for the team's PM during her parental leave.

- **Led the team's product process as interim PM/PO:** running weekly planning, managing the backlog, introducing new product practices, aligning UX, data, and engineering, finding new opportunities, and representing the team in cross-functional meetings.
- **Partner closely with the team's UX designer to set UX/UI directions:** collaborate early to bounce ideas and challenge perspectives before they're shared with the wider team.
- **Turned behavioural data into product direction:** built the user behaviour analytics layer for Partner flows (funnels, notebooks, dashboards) that surfaced drop-off points, informed UX research, and helped define the team's latest initiative.
- **Presented to designers, the UX researcher, and product engineers how to spot UX issues and opportunities** in user behaviour with Datadog RUM and Clarity (funnels, heatmaps, user actions, session recordings).
- **Speed up discovery with AI:** use MCP connections to Metabase to gather data, build dashboards with new metrics, and investigate future opportunities.
- **Aligned Data and Product:** defined key user actions, documented tracking events, and implemented event collection across critical product journeys.
- **Bridged marketing and product:** proposed a process linking active campaign IDs to behavioural data (Datadog, Clarity), extended to traffic-source analysis (ads, organic, direct) with heatmaps, scroll depth, and session recordings to help campaign optimisation and product decisions.

Front End Software Engineer — Holidu GmbH — Munich *Jun 2021 – Jun 2023*

- **Led end-to-end user research for an internal tool:** designed survey methodology, conducted stakeholder interviews, established experience metrics, and co-analysed results to prioritise improvements.
- **Designed feature UIs (e.g. account change history) from low-fidelity sketches to Figma,** iterating on PM and stakeholder feedback before implementation.
- **Bridged engineering and business needs:** collaborated directly with stakeholders to gather requirements and align on solutions, and documented features with functional and technical context for faster onboarding.

Co-Founder / CTO — Moodar — Recife, Brazil *Oct 2016 – Sep 2020*

- **Managed product roadmaps and participated in end-to-end UX processes** to deliver enhanced experiences.
- **Led SCRUM meetings and used Agile methodologies to manage product development** and ensure deliverable features.

SIDE PROJECT

Own Your Sports Stage — Founder (Side Project) *2025 – Present*

Website-building service helping professional footballers move beyond the limited systems (Transfermarkt page, Instagram) currently representing them.

- **Identified a gap in how lower-tier professional footballers represent their careers online** (noticing many were already patching together Instagram highlights and link-in-bio tools to compensate) and built a website service to address it directly.
- **Tested the concept by designing and shipping live websites** for two real athletes, working directly from their own stories (via interviews or provided material) to shape content and design.
- **Currently validating real demand by building outreach and a content strategy** from scratch, including direct conversations with prospective athletes.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. in Computer Science — Federal University of Pernambuco, Brazil — *2011 – 2017*

Study Abroad, Computer Science — Goldsmiths University, London, UK — *2014 – 2015*

SKILLS

Product & Discovery: Product Discovery · UX/UI Collaboration · Roadmap Prioritisation · Backlog Management · Requirements Gathering · Cross-functional Leadership · Agile/Scrum

Research & Analytics: User Research (interviews, surveys) · Behavioural Analytics (Datadog RUM, Clarity) · Funnel & Event Tracking · Metabase

Tools: Figma · Salesforce · Datadog · Clarity · Metabase